

The benefits of using FOSS include lower software costs, higher security and stability (especially with regard to malware), better privacy protection and more control over the hardware.

So, let us take a brief look at one of the key open source software, LibreOffice.

LibreOffice and Apache OpenOffice are two actively developed forks of OpenOffice.org, which is no longer being developed. LibreOffice is being developed by The Document Foundation, and is a powerful and free office suite, used by millions of people around the world. Its clean interface and feature-rich tools help people unleash their creativity and enhance their productivity.

LibreOffice includes several applications that make it the most versatile free and open source office suite in the market. It comes with Writer (word processing), Calc (spreadsheets), Impress (presentations), Draw (vector graphics and flowcharts), Base (databases) and Math (formula editing). Documents look professional and clean, whatever their purpose may be – a letter, a thesis, a brochure, financial reports, marketing presentations, technical drawings and diagrams.

LibreOffice makes the work look great while people focus on the actual content. It is compatible with a wide range of document formats such as Microsoft Word (.doc, .docx), Excel (.xls, .xlsx), PowerPoint (.ppt, .pptx) and Publisher. But LibreOffice goes much further with its native support for a modern and open standard, the Open Document Format (ODF). With LibreOffice, people have maximum control over their data and content and can export their work in many different formats, including PDF.

LibreOffice has a centralised launch centre for all its modules. It was forked from OpenOffice in 2010. Its suite comprises programs for word processing, the creation and

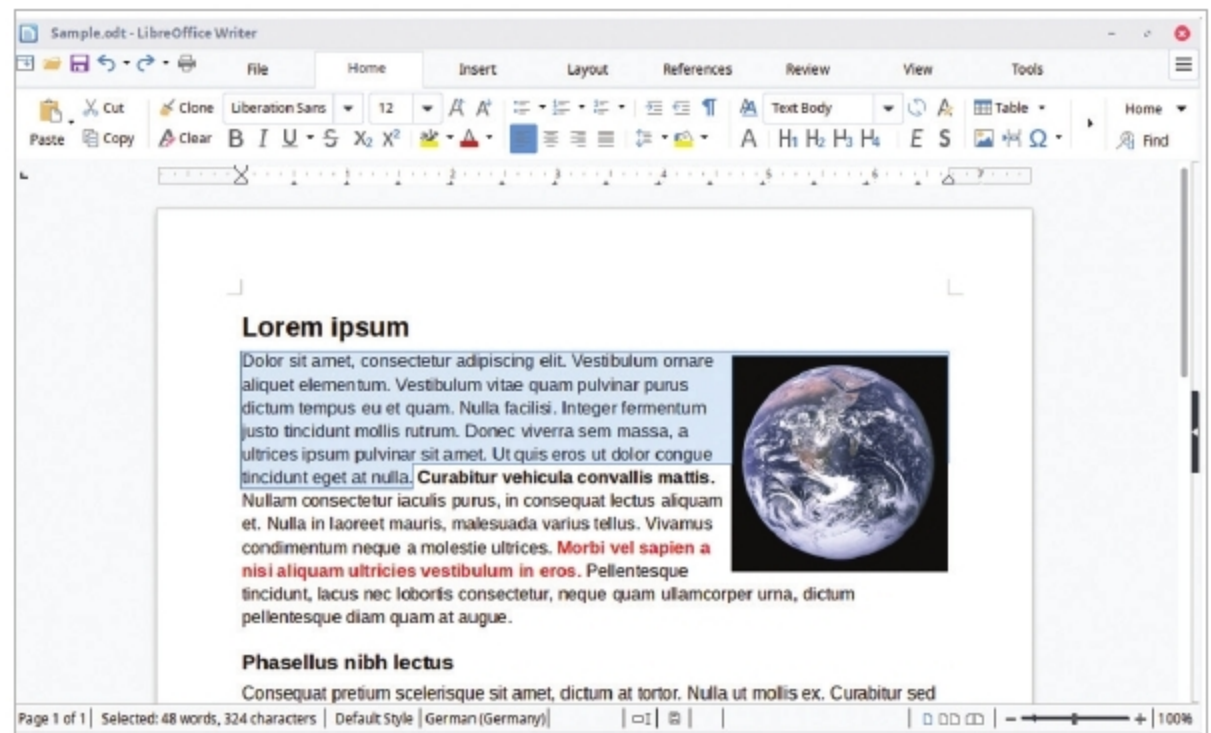


Figure 1: LibreOffice Writer

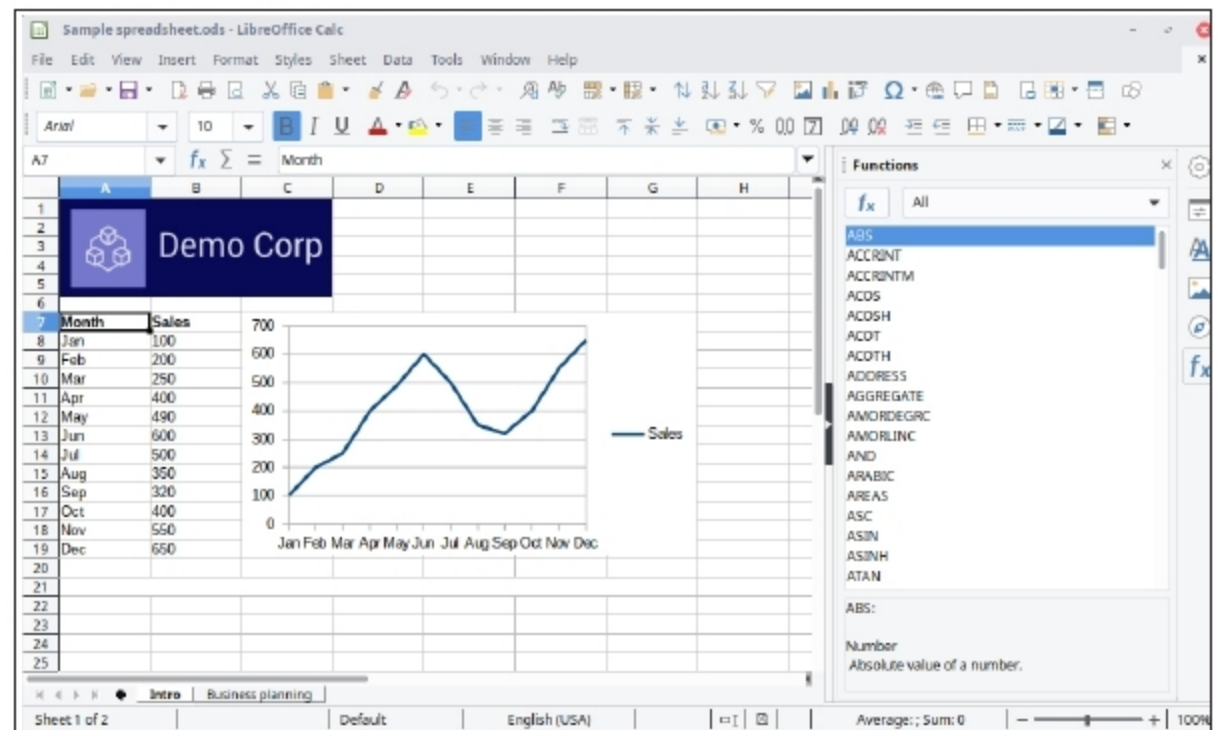


Figure 2: LibreOffice Calc

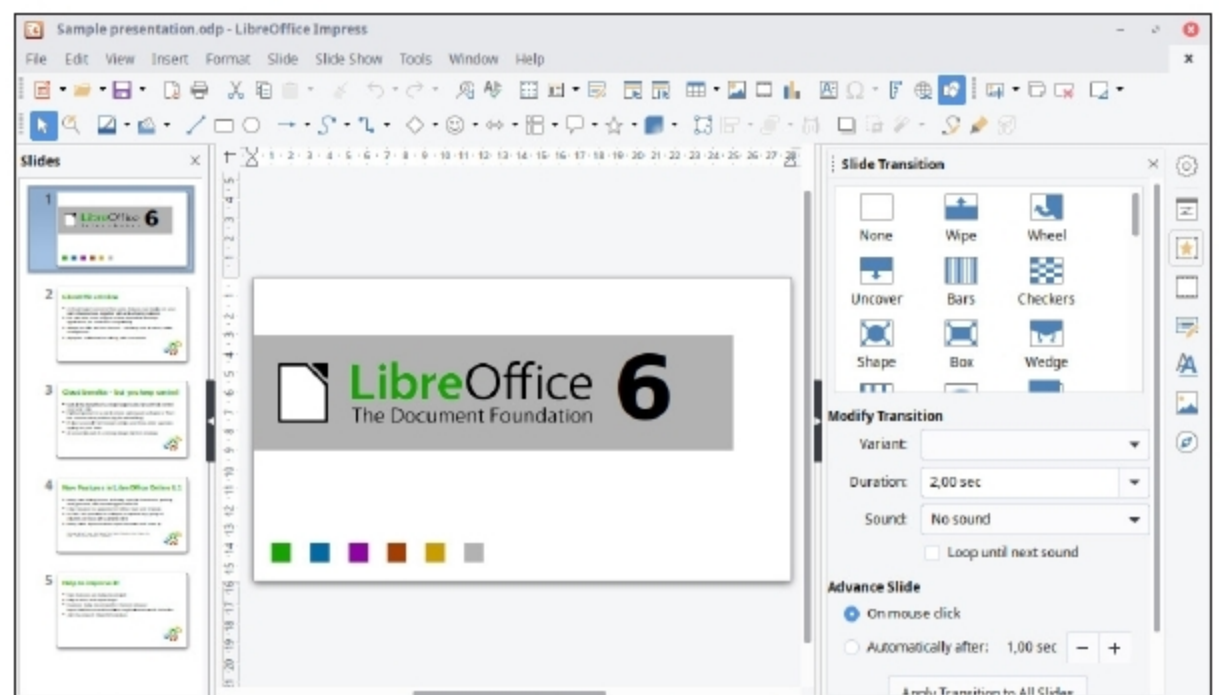


Figure 3: LibreOffice Impress